

Honeycomb source under lock

It has been reported that Google will not release Android 3.0 source code, as there is work to be done on it before it is ready for other devices

Dr. Watson?

A professor of clinical medicine is working to retrofit IBM's super-computer Watson to help doctors diagnose and treat patients

and PCs. Definitely geared towards enterprise users, the device features a new Intel Atom Oaktrail processor, fingerprint scanner, card reader, dual cameras for video conferencing, and even support for stylus input apart from regular finger input.

Other tablets showcased included French manufacturer Archos' low-cost Android tablets, as well as its colour e-reader. Best known for its portable media players, Archos has been previewing and churning out low cost tablets since CES last year, with the Archos 7 Home Tablet making waves amongst others. It introduced three new inexpensive devices at CeBIT: a colour e-reader called Archos 7ob, and two Android tablets – the Archos Arnova 8 and Arnova 10. All these devices are supposedly priced at under ₹10,000, sporting the bare minimum required to do the job – resistive touchscreens,



Archos Arnova Android Tablets

600MHz processors, 4 to 8GB of internal storage, etc.

While Archos' Android 2.1 tablets do not have official access to the Android market, access is guaranteed with a sideloader software, apart from access to Archos' own app store, AppsLib.

MSI showed off a variety of WindPad tablets again, as well as some new form factor concepts. The latest WindPad to be showcased was the WindPad 100-232, which sported an SSD hard disk and ran on Windows 7.

Others to join the tablet party included AOC, which introduced its Breeze tablet that runs on Android and has



a 7-inch display, while Gigabyte showcased its S1080 model, running on Windows 7.

Another major theme at CeBIT was display technology, especially 3D display technology. Organizers Deutsche Messe AG, dedicated a large display entire to 3D, a feature they called 'Next Level 3D.' By this, they mean glasses-free 3D displays, or, autostereoscopic. Technologies showcased included eye-tracking, touch-free, gesture-control, and more. Several manufacturers, from LG to Samsung to Sony and Panasonic, all showcased their autostereoscopic offerings here.

Samsung also showed off a prototype display technology

that is powered by ambient light, making it wirelessly-powered. Featuring a 46-inch transparent LCD display, the prototype had a 1920 x 1080 resolution and supported ten-finger multi-touch input. The display is accompanied by solar cells, which are apparently efficient enough to run on normal, in-house light sources. While for now Samsung's prototype is not going to be able to rival the best LCDs in the market in terms of image quality, of course, we're more than willing to give this interesting technology a chance!

Other major trends at CeBIT included social media, sustainable energy for homes and businesses, smart grids, and the future of the mobile web. Technologies such as Corsair's new and improved Force SSDs, Thermaltake's latest cooling solutions, and Xstreamer's Prodigy media streamer, were also showcased. ■

Sony Dual-View technology aims to make the fight for the remote obsolete

Stereoscopic-displays provide 3D vision by displaying two separate images of the same scene on one screen, one for each eye. Depending on their technology and implementation, viewing angles vary wildly, and though active shutter-glasses technologies don't really suffer from these obstacles, auto-stereoscopic solutions still struggle trying to display an identical stereo-image for viewers located in different parts of a room, who end up seeing either a mono image, or an incorrectly merged stereo-image, in a sig-

nificant portion of the viewing angles.

It looks like Sony has decided to capitalize on this disadvantage of auto-stereoscopic (glasses-free) display technology in their 3D HDTVs in a novel manner, one that seems obvious in hindsight, and can seriously up the usefulness and interface options of the television.

Called Dual-View technology, Sony will soon offer 3D TVs with the ability to display two separate images from two



separate sources, at the same time. What this allows is the ability for individual users to see different images on the screen, simultaneously, when seated at certain angles with respect to the television set. As seen

in the image above, the centre view would probably still be blurred when dual-view is switched on.

The technology behind the innovation is still being developed, and not even a tentative date for production was mentioned. Applications are numerous though, and when coupled with dual-headphone or poly-directional audio features, it can allow two sets of viewers to watch different channels on one television set, at the same time. No more fighting for the remote? ■